

Anna Zhang

annaz94264@gmail.com ♦ (925) 336-2555 ♦ www.linkedin.com/in/annazhang06

EDUCATION

University of California Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA

September 2024 – Present

Bachelor of Science in Cognitive Science

Expected Graduation June 2028

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science: Game Design

Relevant Coursework: Research Methods in Psychology (PSYC 100), Programming Abstractions: Python, Applied Discrete Mathematics, Foundations of Video Game Design, Computer Systems and Assembly Language

GPA: 3.85/4.0, **Dean's List:** 2 Quarters

SKILLS

- **Computer:** Canva, Wordpress, Word, Excel, Adobe Illustrator, PowerPoint, Google Workspace
- **Data & Coding:** Python, C
- **Language:** Mandarin (Professional Working Fluency)
- **Research:** Experimental Design, Literature Review, Participant Recruitment, Conducting Surveys

EXPERIENCE

Santa Cruz Dragon Boat, Santa Cruz, CA

June 2025 – Present

Social Chair

- Increased post reach by 60% and grew follower base by 2% in 2 months by executing targeted Instagram and Tiktok Campaigns @santacruzdragonboat
- Designed digital and print assets (graphics, flyers, merch) to enhance brand visibility and member recruitment.
- Secured \$600+ in partner support through tailored proposals and relationship-building.
- Collaborated with team to align media campaigns with goals, ensuring cohesive messaging across platforms.

Crown Programs Offices - UCSC CHES, Santa Cruz, CA

September 2025 – December 2025

Orientation Welcome Leader

- Collaborated cross-functionally to plan events with attention to student retention, engagement, accessibility, accommodation needs, and inclusive participation.
- Integrated resources in events, like academic support and other support systems to diverse student populations.
- Designed digital and physical posters and flyers with clear and accessible design.

White Stag Leadership Academy, Monterey, CA

September 2021 – September 2024

Senior Patrol Counselor, Assistant Senior Patrol Leader, Patrol Counselor

- Delivered 1,400+ volunteer hours a year while maintaining a full academic course load.
- Designed and led two week-long leadership camp programs serving 100+ youth participants.
- Directed multi-day outdoor experiences, including overnight hikes, leadership games, and team challenges, increasing participant engagement scores by 30% through post-camp surveys.
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Advanced Publications - Foothill HS Yearbook, Pleasanton, CA

August 2021 – June 2024

Design Editor, Staff Member

- Managed yearbook social media marketing, producing campaigns that drove 1,600+ yearbook sales.
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PROJECTS

UCSC Mini Campus Explorer - Team Game Project (2025) - GDevelop, GitHub

- Co-built a top-down campus exploration game with quest systems and published a playable demo in one quarter.
- Ran lightweight playtests with classmates, logged issues in GitHub, and made fixes to hit milestone deadlines.
- Built core loops and event-based logic for NPC hints and interactions with the player.

PSYC 100 Research Infographic (2025) - Google Sheets

- Collaborated with peers to create and present an infographic on findings from conducting surveys from 200 college students between extracurricular participation and academic success, focus on translating data into visuals.
- Wrote literature review based on current research on relationship between extracurriculars and academic success

ACTIVITIES, & HONORS

- **Presidential Volunteer Service Award (Gold)**, Recipient 2022 – 2024
- **Certificate of Merit - Piano Level 10**, Recipient May 2022

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Ben Storm Memory Lab, Santa Cruz, CA

March 2025 – Present

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- Ran 50+ participants for 2 studies and practiced ...

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RELEVANT PROJECTS

UCSC Mini Campus Explorer - Team Game Project (2025) - GDevelop, GitHub

- Defined core product requirements (quest system, NPC interactions) for a team project, translating gameplay goals into scoped, shippable features within a one-quarter timeline
- Ran structured playtests with classmates, informal user research, logged findings as GitHub issues, and prioritized fixes based on player feedback to hit milestone deadlines, an early customer-discovery-to-requirements loop
- Collaborated cross-functionally with designers and developers to scope and build event-based interaction logic against a fixed deadline

PSYC 100 Research Infographic (2025) - Google Sheets

- Conducted survey-based market/user research (n=200 college students) and synthesized existing literature to frame original findings — the same discovery-to-insight structure used to ground a product recommendation
- Translated raw survey data into a visual narrative for a non-technical audience, prioritizing the single relationship (extracurriculars vs. academic success) most relevant to the reader

SKILLS

- **Data & Analysis:** Python, C, Excel, Google Sheets, Survey Design, Data Visualization
- **Product & Research:** User Research, Requirements Definition, Competitive/Literature Analysis, Experimental Design, Participant Recruitment, Cross-Functional Collaboration
- **Software:** Canva, WordPress, Word, Excel, Adobe Illustrator, PowerPoint, Google Workspace
- **Language:** Mandarin (Professional Working Fluency)

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Social Chair

- Analyzed engagement data (post reach, follower growth) across Instagram and TikTok to identify which content formats and messaging resonated, and used those insights to redirect content strategy — increasing post reach 80% and follower base 10% in 6 months
- Partnered cross-functionally with the broader team to align creative execution with organizational goals, and independently secured \$600+ in partner support through tailored proposals and relationship-building

Crown Programs Offices - UCSC CHES, Santa Cruz, CA

September 2025 – December 2025

Orientation Welcome Leader

- Collaborated cross-functionally with staff across departments to plan programming, reconciling competing requirements (accessibility, accommodations, engagement) similar to balancing stakeholder needs in product spec
- Identified gaps in student awareness of available resources and integrated academic/support resources directly into event design to close them

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March 2025 – Present

Research Assistant

- Coordinated recruitment, session facilitation, and data entry for 100+ participants across 2 studies, maintaining rigorous experimental protocol to ensure clean, usable data
- Attended weekly lab meetings and contributed to review of multiple ongoing project presentations, engaging with research design and methodology decisions across the team's portfolio of studies

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UCSC Blueprint, Santa Cruz, CA

March 2025 – Present

External Vice President

- Led brand strategy and communications for Blueprint, using analytics to grow audiences across Instagram, LinkedIn, Medium, and newsletter.
- Created content on all platforms to increase engagement
- Spearheaded corporate and campus partnerships with UCSC clubs and nonprofits, synthesizing data for executive decisions.
- Drove data-driven outreach for fundraisers and the annual summit, maximizing attendance through audience analytics.